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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 1

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This booklet belongs to

_____

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 1 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (9 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (9 pages).

Every page checks itself

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes, and every box on it must follow the rule on the page.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the total printed in the strip (the graph pages add a second sum).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S2-03) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-11, S2-12, S2-13, S2-20) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as stories with more than one step or fewest coins, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size); on the ruler pages a real ruler matches the drawn ruler only at 100%.

What the booklet covers

Syllabus outcome	Wording in the syllabus	Pages
Whole Numbers 1.6	patterns in number sequences	S2-03
Addition and Subtraction 2.1	concepts of addition and subtraction	S2-20
Addition and Subtraction 2.2	use of +, - and =	S2-20
Addition and Subtraction 2.5	adding and subtracting within 100	S2-06, S2-07, S2-13, S2-20
Addition and Subtraction 2.6	adding and subtracting using algorithms	S2-07
Addition and Subtraction 2.7	mental calculation involving addition and subtraction (within 20; 2-digit number and ones without renaming; 2-digit number and tens)	S2-06, S2-12, S2-20
Multiplication and Division 3.1	concepts of multiplication and division	S2-01, S2-04
Multiplication and Division 3.2	use of x	S2-04
Multiplication and Division 3.3	multiplying within 40	S2-04
Multiplication and Division 3.4	dividing within 20	S2-01
Money 1.1	counting amount of money (in cents up to $1; in dollars up to $100)	S2-10, S2-11, S2-12, S2-13
Length 1.1	measuring length in centimetres	S2-08
Length 1.2	use of abbreviation cm	S2-08
Length 1.4	measuring and drawing a line segment to the nearest cm	S2-08
Time 2.1	telling time to 5 minutes	S2-09, S2-14, S2-15, S2-16
Time 2.2	use of 'am' and 'pm'	S2-15
Time 2.3	use of abbreviations h and min	S2-16
Time 2.4	duration of one hour/half hour	S2-14, S2-16
Picture Graphs 1.1	reading and interpreting data from picture graphs	S2-17, S2-18, S2-19

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.2; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.7; Addition and Subtraction 2.3; Addition and Subtraction 2.4; Length 1.3; 2D Shapes 1.1; 2D Shapes 1.2; 2D Shapes 1.3; 2D Shapes 1.4.

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Topic	Tier
S2-01	P1-03	Fair Shares	Sharing equally and making equal groups (within 20)	1 star
S2-03	P1-14	Colour the Ice Cream	Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s	2 stars
S2-04	P1-05	Times Code	Multiplication within 40: groups of, and the missing number	2 stars
S2-06	P1-11	Big Number Sums	Add and subtract within 100	2 stars
S2-07	P1-23	Stack It Up	Adding and subtracting tens and ones, written in boxes (within 100)	1 star
S2-08	P1-32	Measure and Draw	Length in cm: measure a bar and draw a line	1 star
S2-09	P1-06	What Time Is It?	Time: o'clock and half past	1 star
S2-10	P1-15	Coin Purses	Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)	1 star
S2-11	P1-28	Fewest Coins	Money: counting coins in cents; fewest coins and ways to pay	1 star
S2-12	P1-16	Shop Prices	Money: dollars, more and less	2 stars
S2-13	P1-27	Which Two Items?	Money in dollars: which two things cost exactly the amount paid	2 stars
S2-14	P1-18	Clock Time	Time to 5 minutes: 1 hour and half an hour later	2 stars
S2-15	P1-30	Morning or Evening?	Time: am and pm with times to 5 minutes	1 star
S2-16	P1-29	How Long Does It Last?	Time: how long a thing lasts (1 h or 30 min) and when it ends	1 star
S2-17	P1-35	Read the Picture Graph	Picture graphs: read the graph and answer questions	1 star
S2-18	P1-20	Fruit Graph	Picture graphs: read, complete and answer	2 stars
S2-19	P1-36	Graph Detective Two	Picture graphs: read, complete and answer from clues	2 stars
S2-20	P1-22	Two-Step Stories	Two-step stories: add, take away, work backwards	2 stars

Pages are independent. Pick any page. The code in the footer shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 pages (P1-01 to P1-40).